

LOKPAL

- Recommended by **First Administrative Reforms Commission (1966-1970)**. Maharashtra appointed first Lokayukta (1971).
- **Statutory bodies** under Lokpal and Lokayukta Act, 2013. **Lokpal** at Centre, **Lokayukta** in States.
- **Members: Multi-member body:** Chairperson and up to 8 members (50% judicial). Minimum 50% from SC, ST, OBC, Minorities, and Women.
- **Appointment: Lokpal:** By President; **Lokayukta:** By Governor
- **Term:** 5 years or age of 70; **Removal and resignation:** By President.
- **Selection Committee:** PM, Speaker, Opposition Leader, CJI/His Nominee, eminent jurist
- **Search Committee:** Assists selection (50% from marginalised groups)
- **Qualification: Judicial Members:** Current/former SC judges or HC Chief Justices
 - **Non-Judicial Members:** Experts with 25+ years in anti-corruption, public administration, etc. Chairperson salary equivalent to **CJI**, members to SC judges.
- **Function: Superintendence over investigating agencies**, including CBI. **Property attachment and confiscation** powers **Timeline** for enquiry, investigation, and trial. **Enhanced punishment** under Prevention of Corruption Act. Power to grant **prosecution sanction**.
- **Jurisdiction:** Covers **PM, Ministers, MPs, Group A-D officers** and includes **government-financed institutions**. Powers of a civil court; Concept originated in **Sweden (1809)**.

Salient Features of CVC, CIC, & SIC

Attribute	Central Vigilance Commission (CVC)	Central Information Commission (CIC)	State Information Commission (SIC)
Provisions	CVC Act, 2003. As recommended by Santhanam Committee	Statutory bodies under RTI Act 2005	
Head	Chief Vigilance Commissioner	Chief Information Commissioner	State Chief Information Commissioner
Members	Multi-member body: Central Vigilance Commissioners (not more than 2)	CIC + Information Commissioners (not more than 10)	State Chief Information Commissioner & Information Commissioners (not more than 10)
Appointment	By the President on the recommendation of a 3-member committee (PM, Leader of Opposition (LS), and Union Home Minister).	By the President based on a 3-member committee (PM, Leader of Opposition (LS), Union Cabinet Minister nominated by PM)	By the Governor based on a 3-member committee (CM, Leader of Opposition (SLA), State Cabinet Minister nominated by CM).
Term	4 years or age of 65 years, whichever is earlier; not eligible for further appointment	Prescribed by the Central Government or age of 65 years; no reappointment.	Term as prescribed by the State Government; no reappointment.
Qualifications & Salary	Same as UPSC Chairman ; Vigilance Commissioners similar to UPSC members . (cannot be varied detrimentally)	Must be eminent in public life with expertise in law, technology, social service, media, or governance . Cannot be a Member of Parliament , legislature, or hold any office of profit . Salary is determined by the Central Government and cannot be changed to their disadvantage.	
Resignation	To the President	To the President	To the Governor

Removal	By the President on grounds of insolvency, moral turpitude, or infirmity ; requires Supreme Court inquiry for misconduct	By the President on grounds of insolvency, moral turpitude, paid employment outside office, or incapacity (mental/physical).	By the Governor for specific grounds, including misconduct or incapacity
Functions	Supervises CBI in corruption cases. Advises the government on corruption-related investigations. Receives whistleblower complaints under the WhistleBlowers Protection Act (2014) [Protects identity of whistleblowers, imposes penalties for false complaints (up to 2 years imprisonment, Rs. 30,000 fine), requires complainant identification for action]	Receive and investigate complaints related to: - Unavailability of information - Denied requests - Delayed responses - Unreasonable fees - Incomplete/false information Suo-moto inquiry power. Civil court powers during inquiries Enforce compliance of decisions. Impose penalties (up to Rs. 25,000) on Public Information Officers Recommend disciplinary action against errant officials Submit annual reports to respective governments (CIC to Central Government , placed before Parliament , SIC to State Government , placed before State Legislature)	
Additional Points	Powers of a civil court; All India Services, Group A Central Government officers , senior officials in PSUs, Banks, RBI, LIC, etc.	Powers to receive complaints regarding RTI violations and impose penalties	Powers to receive complaints regarding RTI violations and impose penalties

CENTRAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION

- CBI:** Established in 1963 by a resolution of Ministry of Home Affairs, as recommended by the Santhanam Committee (1962-64). **Non-statutory body**, under the **Ministry of Personnel as Attached office**. It derives its powers from the Delhi Special Police Establishment Act.
- Head: Director**
- Members:** Includes **joint directors, deputy inspector generals, superintendents of police**, forensic scientists, and law officers. **Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act (2013)** introduced: **Directorate of Prosecution** to handle cases under the Act, appointed by the Central Govt. on **CVC recommendation**. Appointment of SP and above based on **CVC-chaired committee** recommendations.
- Appointment: 3-member committee: PM (Chair), Leader of Opposition (LS), CJI or SC Judge.**
In the absence of a recognized opposition leader, the **largest opposition party leader** becomes a member.
- Term:** The Director has a Fixed tenure of **2 years** (CVC Act, 2003), extendable up to **5 years** (annual extensions).
- Function:** Investigates **Corruption, economic offences, serious organised crimes** (not terrorism).
- Functions as **National Central Bureau for Interpol India**. Assists CVC, Lokpal, and Lokayukta.

- General Consent:** State consent required for jurisdiction; general consent allows CBI to operate without fresh approval for every case.

NATIONAL INVESTIGATION AGENCY (NIA)

- Founded:** 2009, under National Investigation Agency Act, 2008
- Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Home Affairs.**
- Head:** Director-General powers similar to the Director-General of Police,
- Appointed** by the central government; 5 years or as prescribed; officers' powers extend beyond India for scheduled offences.
- Function:** Collects and analyses counter-terrorism data. Investigates offences listed in the NIA Act. Works with other intelligence agencies. Ensures effective enforcement of the NIA Act. **TFFC(Terror Funding and Fake Currency)** for dealing with fake currency and terror funding Conduct professional investigations using scientific methods. Ensure speedy trials. Covers terror attacks, human trafficking, counterfeit currency, and cyber-terrorism. NIA (Amendment) Act, 2019, Extends jurisdiction to offences committed outside India against Indian citizens. Allows designation of **Special Courts** for NIA-related trials.



Salient Features of Disaster Management Authorities

Attribute	National Disaster Management Authority	State Disaster Management Authority	District Disaster Management Authority
Acts	History: 1999: High Powered Committee formed. 2001: National Committee post-Gujarat Earthquake. 2005: Disaster Management Act enacted after the 2004 Tsunami. Formation: NDMA constituted in 2005 via executive order; notified in 2006. Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Home Affairs.		
Head	Prime Minister (ex-officio chairperson)	Chief Minister (ex-officio chairperson)	Collector/District Magistrate (ex-officio chairperson)
Members	9 Members (not exceeding, with Chairperson and Vice-Chairperson)		Up to 7 Members (with Chairperson) include the chief executive officer, superintendent of police, chief medical officer, and up to two district-level officers.
Appointment	Nominated by the Prime Minister	Nominated by the Chief Minister	Appointed by the state government
Term	Not specified	Not specified	Not specified
Salary	CFI	CFS	Consolidated Fund of State
Functions	Approve National Plan and departmental plans. Establish guidelines for State Disaster Management Authorities (SDMAs). Coordinate policy enforcement and recommend funding for mitigation. Provide international disaster relief and establish minimum standards for disaster relief.		Prepare district disaster management and response plans. Monitor implementation of policies and plans. Identify vulnerable areas and preventive measures. Identify buildings for use as relief centres.
Additional Points	Enhance prevention, preparedness, and resilience at all levels. Identify and monitor disaster risks. Utilise technology and traditional wisdom for mitigation. Integrate disaster management into planning processes. Foster collaboration with the media.		

Salient Features of NHRC & SHRC:

Attribute	National Human Rights Commission (NHRC)	State Human Rights Commission (SHRC)
Acts	Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993	Protection of Human Rights Act, 1993
Head	Chairperson: Retired CJI or Judge of the SC.	Chairperson: Retired CJ or Judge of HC.
Members	5 Members: Serving/retired SC Judge. Serving/retired CJ of HC. 3 others (one woman mandatory) with knowledge/experience in human rights. Ex-officio Members: Chairpersons of NCBC, NCW, NCSC, NCST, NCPDR, NC for Minorities, & Chief Commissioner for PwDs.	2 Members: Serving/retired HC Judge or District Judge (7 years of experience). Expert in human rights.
Appointment	By President . Selection Committee: PM (Chair), Speaker (LS), Deputy Chairman (RS), Opposition Leaders (LS & RS), and Union Home Minister. Consultation with CJI for SC or HC Judge appointments.	By Governor . Selection Committee: CM (Chair), Speaker (SLA), Chairman (SLC), Opposition Leaders (SLA & SLC), and State Home Minister. Consultation with HC Chief Justice .
Term	3 years or until 70 years , whichever earlier.	3 years or until 70 years , earlier.
Salary	Central Govt. determined. Not to vary post-appointment.	State Govt. determined. Not to vary post-appointment.

Resignation	To President	To Governor
Functions	Inquiry into human rights violations or negligence - Suo motu or by petition. Visits to jails and detention centres. Review Constitutional and other legal safeguards and promote human rights literacy. Report Submission to Central/State governments, laid before legislatures. Judicial Powers: Powers of a civil court . Investigative Authority: Own staff and utilisation of government agencies.	
Key Powers	Powers to investigate human rights violations and recommend actions	Powers to investigate human rights violations at the state level
Additional Points	Human Rights Courts: Protection of Human Rights Act (1993) provides for Human Rights Courts in each district for speedy trials. Set up by the State Government with HC Chief Justice's approval. Public Prosecutor: Appointed for these courts (7 years of legal practice mandatory). Removal: NHRC/SHRC Chairperson/Members can be removed by President if: - Declared insolvent. - Engages in paid employment during tenure. Unsound mind or convicted for an offence. Misbehaviour/incapacity (based on SC inquiry recommendation). Limitations: Cannot inquire into matters after 1 year of occurrence. Recommendatory in nature; must be informed about action taken within 1 month . No punitive powers or power to grant relief/compensation . Armed Forces Violations: Limited role; recommendations only.	

Salient Features of NCW, NCPDR & NCM:

Attribute	National Commission for Women (NCW)	National Commission for Protection of Child Rights	National Commission for Minorities (NCM)
Acts	National Commission for Women Act, 1990. Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Women and Child Development. Recommended by Committee on Status of Women in India (1974) and National Perspective Plan for Women (1988) .	National Commissions for Protection of Child Rights Act, 2005. Established in 2007 , based on UN Convention on the Rights of the Child Nodal ministry: Ministry of Women and Child Development.	National Commission for Minorities Act, 1992. The Act does not define 'minority' but allows the Central Government to notify 'minorities' for the Act's purposes. Nodal ministry: Ministry of Minority Affairs.
Head	Chairperson	Chairperson (A person of eminence with contributions to child welfare)	Chairperson
Members	5 Members: Experts in law, legislation, women's employment, social welfare, health, etc. At least one member must belong to the SC and ST community respectively. Member Secretary: Either an expert in management or an officer from Civil Services.	6 Members: Experts in fields like education, child healthcare, juvenile justice, child psychology, and laws related to children, with at least 2 members being women .	7 Members (Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson, 5 members including Chairperson from minority communities) Section 3(2) of NCM Act, 1992
Appointment	Nominated by the Central Government (MoWCD)	Nominated by the Central Government Chair appointed on recommendation of a 3-member selection committee	Nominated by the Central Government from among persons of eminence
Term	3 years	3 years (not more than 2 terms); Chairperson: max 65 years, Members: max 60 years	3 years
Salary	Prescribed by the Central Government	By Central Government; cannot be varied detrimentally	Prescribed by the Central Government

Functions	Reviews legal safeguards for women, recommends legislative measures, facilitates grievance redressal, advises government on policy matters affecting women, Annual reports to the government, with recommendations on safeguards for women, Inspect jails, remand homes , and women's institutions, Fund litigation for cases affecting a large body of women.	Reviews constitutional and legal safeguards for children; examines violations; facilitates grievance redressal; Conduct research and promote awareness Inspect juvenile homes Inquire into child rights violations	Evaluate minority development progress Monitor constitutional and legal safeguards Make recommendations for effective implementation of safeguards Section 9 of the Act. Address specific complaints of rights deprivation. Conduct studies on discrimination and development issues Present periodic reports to Central Government
Key Powers	Appoint committees and regulate procedures. Government must consult NCW on major policy matters. Powers to call for information, summon witnesses, and require production of documents	Powers to inquire into complaints and recommend remedial measures; summon witnesses & documents. Responsibilities Under RTE Act 2009, POCSO Act 2012, and Juvenile Justice Act 2015	Powers of a civil court; can summon and examine witnesses, require document production
Additional Points	Accepts complaints verbally or in writing. Issues addressed include rape, harassment, and domestic violence . Monitors police action and provides counselling. Parivarik Mahila Lok Adalat Established by NCW to assist the District Legal Service Authority in resolving family disputes. Follows the model of Lok Adalat , offering speedy, cost-free justice. NCW provides financial aid to NGOs and State Women's Commissions to organise these Adalats.	Review and ensure child rights safeguards Facilitate grievance redressal . The Commission cannot inquire into matters pending before State Commissions or other statutory commissions. Children's Court: Established under 2005 Act For speedy trials . Designated by state government with High Court Chief Justice's concurrence. Special public prosecutor appointed for each court	Recognized Minorities: Muslims, Christians, Sikhs, Buddhists, Zoroastrians (1993) Jains added in 2014 Annual and special reports to Centre Presented before Parliament with action-taken memorandum State-related reports forwarded to respective state governments. Removal Grounds (Similar to other commissions): Misbehaviour, incapacity, insolvency, conviction, etc.

NITI AAYOG

Extra Constitutional Body, replaced Planning Commission in 2015 (not mentioned in constitution **UPSC 2013**) via a resolution of the Union Cabinet.

- **Head:** Prime Minister of India
- **Member: Governing Council:** Chief Ministers of States and UTs with legislatures, and Lt. Governors of UTs. Salary: Consolidated Fund of India (CFI)
- **Regional Councils:** Address region-specific issues.
- **Special Invitees:** Experts nominated by the Prime Minister.
- **Vice Chairperson:** Appointed by the Prime Minister, with the rank of Cabinet Minister.
- **Full-time Members:** Rank of Minister of State.
- **Part-time Members:** Max 2, from universities/research organisations.
- **Ex-Officio Members:** Max 4, from the Union Council of Ministers.
- **CEO:** Appointed by the Prime Minister.
- **Functions:** Designs policy frameworks, monitors progress, fosters cooperative federalism and a **bottom-up approach**, acts as a think tank. **Policy and programme design** and framework. **Monitoring and evaluation** of schemes and policies. A hub for **knowledge and innovation**.
- **Governance Based on 7 Pillars:** Pro-people, Pro-activity, Participation, Empowering: Inclusion of all, Equality & Transparency
- **NITI Aayog Hubs: Team India Hub:** Interface between Centre and States & **Knowledge and Innovation Hub:** Think-tank focus.
- **Initiatives by NITI Aayog:** 15-year roadmap and 7-year strategy, India@75 vision, Digital India, Atal Innovation Mission, SDG India Index, Composite Water Management Index, SATH Programme, Aspirational Districts Programme, Health Index.

- **Guiding Principles:** Antyodaya, Inclusion, Village Integration, Demographic Dividend, People's Participation, Governance, & Sustainability.

LAW COMMISSION OF INDIA

Non-statutory advisory body established by the Central Government for fixed tenures.

- **Head:** Typically a serving/retired judge or legal expert
- **Members:** Includes full-time members, a member-secretary, and part-time members. Term: 3 years and salary from CFI.
- **Member-Secretary:** Typically an Indian Legal Service officer holding the rank of Additional Secretary/Secretary to the Government.
- **Part-Time Members:** Eminent legal professionals, scholars, or specialists in specific law areas.
- **Function:** Recommend legislative measures for law consolidation and codification. Identify and recommend repeal of outdated laws. Review laws. Advise the government on legal and judicial matters. Provide legal research for foreign countries. Powers to recommend legislative measures, summon witnesses, and require the production of documents. Reports undergo scrutiny by the full Commission before finalisation. Final reports are submitted to the **Ministry of Law and Justice** and then to Parliament.
- To date, the Commission has submitted **289 reports** on various legal issues. **1st Law Commission 1955** under **M.C. Setalvad**. **22nd Law Commission** currently headed by **Justice Ritu Raj Awasthi (2020-2024)**

Salient Features of Bar Councils:

Attribute	Bar Council of India (BCI)	State Bar Councils (SBC)
Acts	Statutory, autonomous body under the Advocates Act, 1961 . Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Law and Justice (Department of Legal Affairs).	Formed under the Advocates Act, 1961 ; 24 SBCs currently exist.
Members	Consists of elected and ex-officio members; includes Attorney-General, Solicitor-General (ex-officio) and one from each State Bar Council (elected).	Elected and ex-officio members. Size based on electorate: 15 (5,000-10,000 voters), 20 (>10,000), 25 (over 10,000). Advocate-General of the state is an ex-officio member.
Functions	Set professional conduct standards for advocates. Supervise SBCs and handle referrals from them. Promote legal education and set educational standards. Recognize universities for law degree qualifications. Conduct legal seminars and provide legal aid for the poor. Acknowledge foreign legal qualifications.	Admit advocates and maintain their roles. Handle misconduct cases against advocates. Promote rights and interests of advocates and bar associations. Conduct seminars, manage funds, and oversee legal aid initiatives.
Additional Points	Powers of a civil court; can summon and examine witnesses, require document production. Funds and Grants: May establish funds for welfare schemes, legal aid, and law libraries. Can receive grants, donations, and memberships in international legal bodies	Powers to regulate legal education and practice in India Funds and Grants: May establish funds for welfare, legal aid, and law libraries. Can receive financial support through grants, donations, and gifts.

Salient Features of CCI & TRAI:

Attribute	Competition Commission of India (CCI)	Telecom Regulatory Authority of India
Articles/Acts	Competition Act, 2002	TRAI Act, 1997
Head	Chair	Chair
Members	5 Members (State & National)	6 Members
Functions	Promotes fair competition; investigates anti-competitive practices; advises on regulations; conducts market studies	Regulates telecommunications; ensures compliance with quality standards; promotes consumer interests
Key Powers	Powers to investigate and prohibit anti-competitive practices	Powers to regulate telecom services and ensure compliance

Salient Features of NIC & NDC:

Aspect	National Integration Council (NIC)	National Development Council (NDC)
Established	1961	1952
Objective	Promote national integration and communal harmony	Facilitate economic development and cooperative federalism
Composition	Chaired by the Prime Minister; includes political leaders and social activists	Chaired by the Prime Minister; includes Chief Ministers and Planning Commission members
Functions	Address issues of national integration, recommend policies for social cohesion	Review and approve Five-Year Plans, discuss socio-economic measures
Focus	Social issues, integration, and harmony	Economic planning and development
Nature	Executive body	Executive body

HOME GUARDS IN INDIA

- **Establishment:** Formed in December 1946 to assist police in civil disturbances and communal riots. The concept was adopted by various states.
- **Central Directive:** Post-1962 Chinese aggression, the Centre advised states to unify existing voluntary organisations into the Home Guards.
- **Raising Authority:** Home Guards are established by state governments under respective state acts, not directly by the Central Government.
- **Roles and Responsibilities**
 - **Auxiliary Support:** Assist police in maintaining internal security.
 - **Emergency Response:** Aid in natural disasters (air raids, fires, cyclones, etc.).
 - **Community Services:** Help maintain essential services, promote communal harmony, and assist vulnerable sections of society.

- **Socio-economic Involvement:** Participate in welfare activities and perform **civil defence duties.**(UPSC 2023)

BORDER WING HOME GUARDS (BWHG)

- **Formation:** 15 battalions raised in border states (e.g., Punjab, Rajasthan, Gujarat) to assist the Border Security Force.
- **Purpose:** Prevent infiltration and safeguard vulnerable areas during external aggression.

CONSUMER COMMISSION

- **Appointment:** Members appointed by the government on Chief Justice's recommendations.
- **Tenure:** 4 years or until age limits are reached.
- **Administrative Control:** National Commission oversees State Commissions.

The **Consumer Protection Act, 2019** establishes a **3-tier redressal system**:

District Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission	State Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission	National Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission
• Setup: Formed by state governments; multiple commissions can exist in one district. • Jurisdiction: Complaints ≤ ₹1 crore (reduced to ₹50 lakhs in 2021). • Composition: President + 2 + members. • Powers: Review orders for errors; function at district headquarters.	• Setup: Established by state governments, typically in state capitals. • Jurisdiction: Complaints between ₹1 crore and ₹10 crores (now ₹50 lakhs to ₹2 crores as of 2021). • Composition: President + 4+ members. • Powers: Declare unfair contracts void; review orders; transfer complaints.	• Setup: Formed by the central government, based in the national capital. • Jurisdiction: Complaints > ₹10 crores (now ₹2 crores in 2021). • Composition: President + 4-11 members (at least one woman). • Powers: Review orders; transfer complaints; appeals to the Supreme Court within 30 days.

Commission	2021 Rules	2019 Act	1986 Act
District Commission	Up to ₹50 lakhs	Up to ₹1 crore	Up to ₹20 lakhs
State Commission	₹50 lakhs to ₹2 crores	₹1 crore to ₹10 crores	₹20 lakhs to ₹1 crore
National Commission	Above ₹2 crores	Above ₹10 crores	Above ₹1 crore

